

The Boston Globe

Serving our community since 1872

TUESDAY, MARCH 3, 2026

‘Whatever it takes,’ Trump says of war

Officials talk of protracted, intensifying attacks on Iran

By Shawn McCreesh,
Tyler Pager,
and Eric Schmitt

NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — President Trump said Monday the United States would continue attacking Iran for as long as it took to leave it incapable of posing a threat, an indication that an expanding war in the Middle East could continue for weeks or more.

“Whatever the time is, it’s OK, whatever it takes,” Trump said at an event at the White House, in his first public comments on the war since US-Israeli airstrikes on Iran began Saturday. “Right from the beginning we projected four to five weeks, but we have the capability to go far longer than that,” he added. “We’ll do it.”

The Trump administration
IRAN, Page A4



Observers gathered on a hillside overlooking Tehran as US and Israeli forces continued their strikes.

MAJID SAEEDI/GETTY IMAGES

D.C. debate

Congress grapples with how to respond to a quickly intensifying war. **A5.**

Increase in troops

“This work is just beginning,” said the chair of the Joint Chiefs of Staff. **A6.**

Destroying missiles a difficult challenge

By John Ismay

NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — At the White House on Monday, President Trump said destroying Iran’s missile capabilities was one of the top objectives of the US attacks in the country.

But finding and destroying Iran’s arsenal of ballistic missiles as well as their production sites could be particularly challenging for the US and Israeli militaries, which jointly began attacking Iran on Saturday.

Airstrikes alone cannot destroy the plans and
MISSILES, Page A4

Refusal to sell home alters Y’s expansion

Pricey offers, pastry gifts can’t seal deal

By Spencer Buell

GLOBE STAFF

SOMERVILLE — Again and again they have asked. And every time, the answer has been the same:

No.

For several years, leadership at the Somerville YMCA has tried to strike a deal with its neighbor, an unassuming two-story home at the corner of Highland Avenue and School Street.

Their plan to replace the city’s crumbling old facility with a gleaming new one four times its size, and with scores of new units of affordable housing, hinged in part on buying the family home and building on top of it.

But even as they have offered ever more money, the owners of the house with the curved stoop and the garden out front have made it clear they aren’t going anywhere.

So now, as the Y begins final-

izing a planned expansion, a decision has been made that may reverberate through the decades: Instead of buying the home, they will simply build around it.

\$2.5M

The Y’s current offer for the Topouzoglou property, \$1M more than the city’s assessed value of the home.

“We really upped the ante in the last few years to work with them to reach a deal,” said Vladimir Benoit, the Y’s CEO. But, he said, “we couldn’t wait anymore.”

The troubles at the Y began well before the Topouzoglou family arrived on the block in the 1980s, settling in the property right across from Somerville High School.

Immigrants from Greece, they raised four children in the home and lived comfortably in the neighborhood despite never being fully confident in their English. They gave their corner of the intersection curb appeal, planting dahlias, hibiscus, and peonies in a lush garden and surrounding it with decorative

YMCA, Page A7



LANE TURNER/GLOBE STAFF

A train passes near a proposed bike bridge over the Mystic.

So close to Boston, so far for commuters

Everett residents list litany of travel laments. Could mass transit help?

By Jaime Moore-Carrillo

GLOBE STAFF

EVERETT — The heart of Everett, a working-class city shedding its industrial past, sits roughly 3 miles from Boston City Hall. From his office, Everett’s new mayor can clearly make out the towers forming Boston’s skyline.

Yet for some, the two cities don’t feel all that close. Everett is one of just three of the roughly dozen communities bordering Boston without a subway or commuter rail station. The region’s notorious traffic awaits those trying to drive between the two.

“Our geography as a commu-

nity is our greatest asset,” Mayor Robert Van Campen said. “But the issue is we are so close to everything and yet so disconnected from everything.”

Perhaps that will change.

A web of projects — including an extended Silver Line route, a new pedestrian and cycling bridge connecting Everett to Somerville, and a possible commuter rail stop — could make it easier to ride a bike, bus, or train in and out of some parts of the city.

City officials also hope the projects will create easier access to the flagship developments on the horizon, including a professional soccer stadium set to rise on the banks of the Mystic River. “We have to plug in all the right public transit options in order to make it all work,” Van Campen said.

Today, transit trips between Boston’s urban core and Ever-

EVERETT, Page A10

In pastoral Western Mass., solar proposals spark bitter fights among neighbors



KEN MCGAGH FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

A lone pedestrian on Huntington Road in Worthington, one of the towns facing disputes over green energy.

Generating more heat than light

By Kate Selig

GLOBE STAFF

WORTHINGTON — Helen Sharron Pollard and the couple down the road, Timothy Sena and Catherine Rude-Sena, had been neighborly for decades, stretching back to when Pollard picked potatoes on the Senas’ farm to earn money for college.

That is, until the Senas proposed last year to install over 6,000 solar panels on their land in Worthington, a sparsely populated town in the foothills of the Berkshires.

To the Senas, both in their 70s, the panels were a path

SOLAR, Page A10

Deep disparities persist among buildings in different school districts, even as the overall infrastructure has improved. **B1.**

France pledged to expand its nuclear arsenal and cooperation with neighbors to deter attacks as US steps back. **A3.**



For breaking news, updated stories, and more, visit our website:

BostonGlobe.com

Mixing it; up

Tuesday: A few drops, flakes. High 35-40, low 31-36.

Wednesday: Temps rising. High 46-51, low 28-33.

Weather and comics, **D5-6.** Obituaries, **C9.**

VOL. 309, NO. 62

*

Suggested retail price
\$4.00



0 947725 4